

there's another reason D'Anna thinks paying interns benefits any company: diversity, just as Sterne said.

D'Anna, who in 2004 started the CohnReznick women's program and now serves on the firm's diversity inclusion initiative council, said CohnReznick's 150 interns are often paying their way through school and would struggle unduly by taking an unpaid internship. She said they've seen that an intern's work ethic drastically changes for the better when they can afford to be interning.

The ones who can't afford their unpaid internships have begun fighting back. According to the *Huffington Post*, in 2015 my former employer Viacom paid \$7.2 million to 12,500 former interns across their networks in a class action lawsuit. The suit was filed in 2013, so I missed the cut by four years. It alleged, as I do, that the work was comparable to that of employees. The Viacom internship now pays. In a 2013 class action lawsuit, unpaid interns on the Darren Aronofsky film *Black Swan* sued Fox Searchlight over their poor treatment on that film. But labor attorneys have historically had trouble finding people willing to jeopardize their career by suing their first employer, which makes sense.

Eisenbrey said he believes unpaid internships give employers the idea that you're desperate. For instance, when someone applies for a job with multiple unpaid internships, he says it tells him that "the employer didn't take them as seriously" and "that they're willing to work for nothing. Therefore, I can give them a lower salary offer than I would someone who had worked a real job, or an internship where they were paid."

I brought up my theory that even if I didn't get hired at *The Daily Show* directly after my internship, having the show on my résumé may have piqued future employers' interests in me. Maybe it made them take a second look at my résumé in the pile. Eisenbrey said there're no data to support that. The only worth an internship has for your future is if you're actually learning something useful. That is, it's an educational internship (like at CohnReznick, perhaps) and not one where you're picking up dry cleaning or getting coffee, no matter